Stellar Cyber 6.6.0s is now live! Discover all the updates in the release notes!

Rules Contributing to Suspicious Windows Service Installation Alert

The following rules are used to identify suspicious activity with service installation activity. Any one or more of these will trigger the Suspicious Windows Service Installation Alert. Details for each rule can be viewed by clicking the **More Details** link in the description.

Windows Events Required: 4697

The Windows Detect Profile (Low Volume) covers these required Windows events.

Title	Description

Invoke-Obfuscation VAR++ LAUNCHER OBFUSCATION - Security	Detects Obfuscated Powershell via VAR++ LAUNCHER
	
	More details
	
	Rule ID
	`windows_security_1`
	
	Query
	`{'selection': {'EventID': 4697, 'ServiceFileName|contains|all': ['&&set', 'cmd', '/c', '-f'], 'ServiceFileName|contains': ['{0}', '{1}', '{2}', '{3}', '{4}', '{5}']}, 'condition': 'selection'}`
	
	Log Source
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	• Collecting Windows security events
	• The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697
	
	Rule Source
	SigmaHQ,4c54ba8f-73d2-4d40-8890-d9cf1dca3d30
	
	Author: Timur Zinniatullin, oscd.community
	
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
	TA0002, T1059.001, TA0005, T1027
	
	References

Title	Description
	https://github.com/SigmaHQ/sigma/issues/1009 **Severity** 75 **Suppression Logic Based On** • event_id • computer_name • stellar.rule_id **Additional Information** **Maturity**: test **Creation Date**: 2020/10/13 **Risk Level**: high **False Positives** • Unknown

Malicious Service Installations	Detects known malicious service installs that only appear in cases of lateral movement, credential dumping, and other suspicious activities.
	More details
	Rule ID
	`windows_security_8`
	Query
	`{'selection': {'EventID': 4697}, 'malsvc_apt29': {'ServiceName': 'javamtsup'}, 'condition': 'selection and 1 of malsvc_*'}`
	Log Source
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	• Collecting Windows security events
	• The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697
	Rule Source
	SigmaHQ,cb062102-587e-4414-8efa-dbe3c7bf19c6
	Author: Florian Roth (Nextron Systems), Daniil Yugoslavskiy, oscd.community (update)
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
	TA0002, T1569.002, TA0003, T1543.003, TA0006, T1003
	References
	• https://awakesecurity.com/blog/threat-hunting-for-paexec/
	• https://www.fireeye.com/blog/threat-research/2017/05/wannacry-malware-profile.html
	• https://blog.f-secure.com/wp-content/uploads/2019/10/CosmicDuke.pdf
	Severity
	90
	Suppression Logic Based On
	• event_id
	• computer_name
	• stellar.rule_id
	Additional Information
	Maturity: test
	Creation Date: 2017/03/27
	Risk Level: critical
	False Positives
	• Unknown

Title	Description

Invoke-Obfuscation Via Use MSHTA - Security	Detects Obfuscated Powershell via use MSHTA in Scripts
	
	More details
	
	Rule ID
	
	`windows_security_10`
	
	Query
	
	`{'selection': {'EventID': 4697, 'ServiceFileName|contains|all': ['mshta', 'vbscript:createobject', '.run', 'window.close']}, 'condition': 'selection'}`
	
	Log Source
	
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	
	• Collecting Windows security events
	• The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697
	
	Rule Source
	
	SigmaHQ,9b8d9203-4e0f-4cd9-bb06-4cc4ea6d0e9a
	
	Author: Nikita Nazarov, oscd.community
	
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
	
	TA0002, T1059.001, TA0005, T1027
	
	References
	
	• https://github.com/SigmaHQ/sigma/issues/1009
	
	Severity
	
	75
	
	Suppression Logic Based On
	
	• event_id
	• computer_name
	• stellar.rule_id
	
	Additional Information
	
	Maturity: experimental
	Creation Date: 2020/10/09
	Risk Level: high
	False Positives:
	• Unknown

Service Installed By Unusual Client - Security	Detects a service installed by a client which has PID 0 or whose parent has PID 0
	
	More details
	
	Rule ID
	
	`windows_security_13`
	
	Query
	
	`{'selection': {'EventID': 4697}, 'selection_pid': [{'ClientProcessId': 0}, {'ParentProcessId': 0}], 'condition': 'all of selection*'}`
	
	Log Source
	
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	
	• Collecting Windows security events
	• The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697

Title	Description
	Source SigmaHQ,c4e92a97-a9ff-4392-9d2d-7a4c642768ca Author: Tim Rauch (Nextron Systems), Elastic (idea) **Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures** TA0003, T1543 **References** • https://www.elastic.co/guide/en/security/current/windows-service-installed-via-an-unusual-client.html • https://twitter.com/SBousseaden/status/1490608838701166596 **Severity** 75 **Suppression Logic Based On** • event_id • computer_name • stellar.rule_id **Additional Information** Maturity: experimental Creation Date: 2022/09/15 Risk Level: high False Positives: • Unknown

Meterpreter or Cobalt Strike Getsystem Service Installation - Security	Detects the use of getsystem Meterpreter/Cobalt Strike command by detecting a specific service installation
	More details
	Rule ID
	`windows_security_26`
	Query
	`{'selection_id': {'EventID': 4697}, 'selection': [{'ServiceFileName|contains|all': ['cmd', '/c', 'echo', '\\pipe\\']}, {'ServiceFileName|contains|all': ['%COMSPEC%', '/c', 'echo', '\\pipe\\']}, {'ServiceFileName|contains|all': ['cmd.exe', '/c', 'echo', '\\pipe\\']}, {'ServiceFileName|contains|all': ['rundll32', '.dll,a', '/p:']}], 'condition': 'selection_id and selection'}`
	Log Source
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	• Collecting Windows security events
	• The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697
	Rule Source
	SigmaHQ,ecbc5e16-58e0-4521-9c60-eb9a7ea4ad34
	Author: Teymur Kheirkhabarov, Ecco, Florian Roth (Nextron Systems)
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
	TA0005, T1134
	References
	• https://speakerdeck.com/heirhabarov/hunting-for-privilege-escalation-in-windows-environment

Title	Description
	https://blog.cobaltstrike.com/2014/04/02/what-happens-when-i-type-getsystem/ **Severity** 90 **Suppression Logic Based On** • event_id • computer_name • stellar.rule_id **Additional Information** **Maturity**: test **Creation Date**: 2019/10/26 **Risk Level**: critical **False Positives**: • Highly unlikely

Invoke-Obfuscation RUNDLL LAUNCHER - Security	Detects Obfuscated Powershell via RUNDLL LAUNCHER
	
	More details
	
	Rule ID
	
	`windows_security_32`
	
	Query
	
	`{'selection': {'EventID': 4697, 'ServiceFileName|contains|all': ['rundll32.exe', 'shell32.dll', 'shellexec_rundll', 'powershell']}, 'condition': 'selection'}`
	
	Log Source
	
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	• Collecting Windows security events
	• The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697
	
	Rule Source
	
	SigmaHQ,f241cf1b-3a6b-4e1a-b4f9-133c00dd95ca
	
	Author: Timur Zinniatullin, oscd.community
	
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
	
	TA0002, T1059.001, TA0005, T1027
	
	References
	• https://github.com/SigmaHQ/sigma/issues/1009
	
	Severity
	
	50
	
	Suppression Logic Based On
	• event_id
	• computer_name
	• stellar.rule_id
	
	Additional Information
	Maturity: experimental
	Creation Date: 2020/10/18
	Risk Level: medium
	False Positives: • Unknown

Invoke-Obfuscation Via Use Rundll32 - Security	Detects Obfuscated Powershell via use Rundll32 in Scripts More details **Rule ID**

Title	Description
	dows_security_33 **Query** `{'selection': {'EventID': 4697, 'ServiceFileName|contains|all': ['&&', 'rundll32', 'shell32.dll', 'shellexec_rundll'], 'ServiceFileName|contains': ['value', 'invoke', 'comspec', 'iex']}, 'condition': 'selection'}` **Log Source** Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for: • Collecting Windows security events • The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697 **Rule Source** SigmaHQ,cd0f7229-d16f-42de-8fe3-fba365fbcb3a Author: Nikita Nazarov, oscd.community **Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures** TA0002, T1059.001, TA0005, T1027 **References** • https://github.com/SigmaHQ/sigma/issues/1009 **Severity** 75 **Suppression Logic Based On** • event_id • computer_name • stellar.rule_id **Additional Information** **Maturity**: experimental **Creation Date**: 2020/10/09 **Risk Level**: high **False Positives**: • Unknown

Invoke-Obfuscation STDIN+ Launcher - Security	Detects Obfuscated use of stdin to execute PowerShell
	
	More details
	
	Rule ID
	
	`windows_security_50`
	
	Query
	
	`{'selection': {'EventID': 4697, 'ServiceFileName|contains|all': ['cmd', 'powershell']}, 'selection2': {'ServiceFileName|contains': ['${input}', 'noexit']}, 'selection3': {'ServiceFileName|contains': [' /c ', ' /r ']}, 'condition': 'all of selection*'}`
	
	Log Source
	
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	
	• Collecting Windows security events
	• The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697
	
	Rule Source
	
	SigmaHQ,0c718a5e-4284-4fb9-b4d9-b9a50b3a1974

Title	Description
	 or: Jonathan Cheong, oscd.community **Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures** TA0002, T1059.001, TA0005, T1027 **References** • https://github.com/SigmaHQ/sigma/issues/1009 **Severity** 75 **Suppression Logic Based On** • event_id • computer_name • stellar.rule_id **Additional Information** **Maturity**: experimental **Creation Date**: 2020/10/15 **Risk Level**: high **False Positives** • Unknown

Invoke-Obfuscation Via Stdin - Security	Detects Obfuscated Powershell via Stdin in Scripts
	More details
	Rule ID
	`windows_security_53`
	Query
	`{'selection': {'EventID': 4697, 'ServiceFileName|contains|all': ['set', '&&'], 'ServiceFileName|contains': ['environment', 'invoke', '${input)']}, 'condition': 'selection'}`
	Log Source
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	• Collecting Windows security events
	• The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697
	Rule Source
	SigmaHQ,80b708f3-d034-40e4-a6c8-d23b7a7db3d1
	Author: Nikita Nazarov, oscd.community
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
	TA0002, T1059.001, TA0005, T1027
	References
	• https://github.com/SigmaHQ/sigma/issues/1009
	Severity
	75
	Suppression Logic Based On
	• event_id
	• computer_name
	• stellar.rule_id
	Additional Information

Title	Description			
	Maturity	**Creation Date**	**Risk Level**	**False Positives**
	experimental	2020/10/12	high	• Unknown

Invoke-Obfuscation CLIP+ Launcher - Security	Detects Obfuscated use of Clip.exe to execute PowerShell
	
	More details
	
	Rule ID
	`windows_security_55`
	
	Query
	`{'selection': {'EventID': 4697, 'ServiceFileName|contains|all': ['cmd', '&&', 'clipboard]::']}, 'condition': 'selection'}`
	
	Log Source
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	• Collecting Windows security events
	• The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697
	
	Rule Source
	SigmaHQ,4edf51e1-cb83-4e1a-bc39-800e396068e3
	
	Author: Jonathan Cheong, oscd.community
	
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
	TA0002, T1059.001, TA0005, T1027
	
	References
	• https://github.com/SigmaHQ/sigma/issues/1009
	
	Severity
	75
	
	Suppression Logic Based On
	• event_id
	• computer_name
	• stellar.rule_id
	
	Additional Information			

	Maturity	**Creation Date**	**Risk Level**	**False Positives**
	experimental	2020/10/13	high	• Unknown

Metasploit Or Impacket Service Installation Via SMB PsExec	Detects usage of Metasploit SMB PsExec (exploit/windows/smb/psexec) and Impacket psexec.py by triggering on specific service installation
	
	More details
	
	Rule ID
	`windows_security_61`
	
	Query
	`{'selection': {'EventID': 4697, 'ServiceFileName|re': '^%systemroot%\\\\[a-zA-Z]{8}\\.exe$', 'ServiceName\|re': '(^[a-zA-Z]{4}$)|(^[a-zA-Z]{8}$)\|(^[a-zA-Z]{16}$)', 'ServiceStartType': '3', 'ServiceType': '0x10'},`			

Title	Description
	lter': {'ServiceName': 'PSEXESVC'}, 'condition': 'selection and not filter'} **Log Source** Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for: • Collecting Windows security events • The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697 **Rule Source** SigmaHQ,6fb63b40-e02a-403e-9ffd-3bcc1d749442 Author: Bartlomiej Czyz, Relativity **Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures** TA0002, T1569.002, TA0008, T1021.002, T1570 **References** • https://bczyz1.github.io/2021/01/30/psexec.html **Severity** 75 **Suppression Logic Based On** • event_id • computer_name • stellar.rule_id **Additional Information** **Maturity**: experimental **Creation Date**: 2021/01/21 **Risk Level**: high **False Positives**: • Possible, different agents with a 8 character binary and a 4, 8 or 16 character service name
Invoke-Obfuscation Obfuscated IEX Invocation - Security	Detects all variations of obfuscated powershell IEX invocation code generated by Invoke-Obfuscation framework from the code block linked in the references More details **Rule ID** windows_security_71 **Query** {'selection_eid': {'EventID': 4697}, 'selection_servicefilename': [{'ServiceFileName|re': '\\$PSHome\\[\\s*\\d{1,3}\\s*\\]\\s*\\+\\s*\\$PSHome\\['}, {'ServiceFileName|re': '\\$ShellId\\[\\s*\\d{1,3}\\s*\\]\\s*\\+\\s*\\$ShellId\\['}, {'ServiceFileName|re': '\\$env:Public\\[\\s*\\d{1,3}\\s*\\]\\s*\\+\\s*\\$env:Public\\['}, {'ServiceFileName|re': '\\$env:ComSpec\\[(\\s*\\d{1,3}\\s*,){2}'}, {'ServiceFileName|re': '*mdr*\\W\\s*\\)\\.Name'}, {'ServiceFileName|re': '\\$VerbosePreference\\.ToString\\('}, {'ServiceFileName|re': '\\String\\]\\s*\\$VerbosePreference'}], 'condition': 'all of selection_*'} **Log Source** Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:

Title	Description
	• Collecting Windows security events • The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697 **Rule Source** SigmaHQ,fd0f5778-d3cb-4c9a-9695-66759d04702a Author: Daniel Bohannon (@Mandiant/@FireEye), oscd.community **Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures** TA0005, T1027 **References** • https://github.com/danielbohannon/Invoke-Obfuscation/blob/f20e7f843edd0a3a7716736e9eddfa423395dd26/Out-ObfuscatedStringCommand.ps1#L873-L888 **Severity** 75 **Suppression Logic Based On** • event_id • computer_name • stellar.rule_id **Additional Information** **Maturity**: experimental **Creation Date**: 2019/11/08 **Risk Level**: high **False Positives**: • Unknown

Invoke-Obfuscation Via Use Clip - Security	Detects Obfuscated Powershell via use Clip.exe in Scripts
	
	More details
	
	Rule ID
	
	`windows_security_76`
	
	Query
	
	`{'selection': {'EventID': 4697, 'ServiceFileName|contains': '(Clipboard|i'}, 'condition': 'selection'}`
	
	Log Source
	
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	
	• Collecting Windows security events
	• The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697
	
	Rule Source
	
	SigmaHQ,1a0a2ff1-611b-4dac-8216-8a7b47c618a6
	
	Author: Nikita Nazarov, oscd.community
	
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
	
	TA0002, T1059.001, TA0005, T1027
	
	References
	
	• https://github.com/SigmaHQ/sigma/issues/1009
	
	Severity
	
	75
	
	Suppression Logic Based On

Title	Description
	 • event_id • computer_name • stellar.rule_id **Additional Information** **Maturity**: experimental **Creation Date**: 2020/10/09 **Risk Level**: high **False Positives**: • Unknown

Invoke-Obfuscation VAR+ Launcher - Security	Detects Obfuscated use of Environment Variables to execute PowerShell
	More details
	Rule ID
	`windows_security_90`
	Query
	`{'selection': {'EventID': 4697, 'ServiceFileName|contains|all': ['cmd', '"set', '-f'], 'ServiceFileName|contains': ['/c', '/r']}, 'condition': 'selection'}`
	Log Source
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	• Collecting Windows security events
	• The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697
	Rule Source
	SigmaHQ,dcf2db1f-f091-425b-a821-c05875b8925a
	Author: Jonathan Cheong, oscd.community
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
	TA0002, T1059.001, TA0005, T1027
	References
	• https://github.com/SigmaHQ/sigma/issues/1009
	Severity
	75
	Suppression Logic Based On
	• event_id
	• computer_name
	• stellar.rule_id
	Additional Information
	Maturity: experimental
	Creation Date: 2020/10/15
	Risk Level: high
	False Positives: • Unknown

Invoke-Obfuscation COMPRESS OBFUSCATION - Security	Detects Obfuscated Powershell via COMPRESS OBFUSCATION
	More details
	Rule ID
	`windows_security_102`
	Query
	`{'selection': {'EventID': 4697, 'ServiceFileName|contains|all': ['new-`

Title	Description
	 `ect', 'text.encoding]::ascii', 'readtoend'], 'ServiceFileName|contains': ['system.io.compression.deflatestream', 'system.io.streamreader']}, 'condition': 'selection'}` **Log Source** Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for: • Collecting Windows security events • The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697 **Rule Source** SigmaHQ,7a922f1b-2635-4d6c-91ef-af228b198ad3 Author: Timur Zinniatullin, oscd.community **Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures** TA0002, T1059.001, TA0005, T1027 **References** • https://github.com/SigmaHQ/sigma/issues/1009 **Severity** 50 **Suppression Logic Based On** • event_id • computer_name • stellar.rule_id **Additional Information** **Maturity**: experimental **Creation Date**: 2020/10/18 **Risk Level**: medium **False Positives** • Unknown

PowerShell Scripts Installed as Services - Security	Detects powershell script installed as a Service
	
	More details
	
	Rule ID
	
	`windows_security_106`
	
	Query
	
	`{'selection': {'EventID': 4697, 'ServiceFileName|contains': ['powershell', 'pwsh']}, 'condition': 'selection'}`
	
	Log Source
	
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	• Collecting Windows security events
	• The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697
	
	Rule Source
	
	SigmaHQ,2a926e6a-4b81-4011-8a96-e36cc8c04302
	
	Author: oscd.community, Natalia Shornikova
	
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
	
	TA0002, T1569.002
	
	References
	• https://speakerdeck.com/heirhabarov/hunting-for-powershell-abuse

Title	Description
	rity 75 **Suppression Logic Based On** • event_id • computer_name • stellar.rule_id **Additional Information** **Maturity**: test **Creation Date**: 2020/10/06 **Risk Level**: high **False Positives** • Unknown

HybridConnectionManager Service Installation	Rule to detect the Hybrid Connection Manager service installation.
	
	More details
	
	Rule ID
	`windows_security_110`
	
	Query
	`{'selection': {'EventID': 4697, 'ServiceName': 'HybridConnectionManager', 'ServiceFileName|contains': 'HybridConnectionManager'}, 'condition': 'selection'}`
	
	Log Source
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	• Collecting Windows security events
	• The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697
	
	Rule Source
	SigmaHQ,0ee4d8a5-4e67-4faf-acfa-62a78457d1f2
	
	Author: Roberto Rodriguez (Cyb3rWard0g), OTR (Open Threat Research)
	
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
	TA0003, T1554
	
	References
	• https://twitter.com/Cyb3rWard0g/status/1381642789369286662
	
	Severity
	75
	
	Suppression Logic Based On
	• event_id
	• computer_name
	• stellar.rule_id
	
	Additional Information
	Maturity: test
	Creation Date: 2021/04/12
	Risk Level: high
	False Positives
	• Legitimate use of Hybrid Connection Manager via Azure function apps.

Tap Driver Installation - Security	Well-known TAP software installation. Possible preparation for data exfiltration using tunnelling techniques More details

Title	Description

	ID
	`windows_security_114`
	Query
	`{'selection': {'EventID': 4697, 'ServiceFileName|contains': 'tap0901'}, 'condition': 'selection'}`
	Log Source
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	• Collecting Windows security events
	• The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697
	Rule Source
	SigmaHQ,9c8afa4d-0022-48f0-9456-3712466f9701
	Author: Daniil Yugoslavskiy, Ian Davis, oscd.community
	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
	TA0010, T1048
	References
	N/A
	Severity
	50
	Suppression Logic Based On
	• event_id
	• computer_name
	• stellar.rule_id
	Additional Information
	Maturity test
	Creation Date 2019/10/24
	Risk Level medium
	False Positives
	• Legitimate OpenVPN TAP insntallation

Credential Dumping Tools Service Execution - Security	Detects well-known credential dumping tools execution via service execution events
	More details
	Rule ID
	`windows_security_128`
	Query
	`{'selection': {'EventID': 4697, 'ServiceFileName|contains': ['fgexec', 'dumpsvc', 'cachedump', 'mimidrv', 'gsecdump', 'servpw', 'pwdump']}, 'condition': 'selection'}`
	Log Source
	Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor configured for:
	• Collecting Windows security events
	• The 'System Security Extension' audit subcategory need to be enabled to log the EID 4697
	Rule Source
	SigmaHQ,f0d1feba-4344-4ca9-8121-a6c97bd6df52
	Author: Florian Roth (Nextron Systems), Teymur Kheirkhabarov, Daniil Yugoslavskiy, oscd.community

Title	Description

cs, Techniques, and Procedures

TA0002, T1569.002, TA0006, T1003

References

- https://www.slideshare.net/heirhabarov/hunting-for-credentials-dumping-in-windows-environment

Severity

75

Suppression Logic Based On

- event_id
- computer_name
- stellar.rule_id

Additional Information

Maturity	Creation Date	Risk Level	False Positives
test	2017/03/05	high	• Legitimate Administrator using credential dumping tool for password recovery

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